

MOROCCO

OCTOBER 2015 – JUNE 2026

Prepared by Africa INSIGHTS Research Team | Vertical: Travel & Tourism

Morocco's travel perception sits well below the regional floor, driven by a negative majority and the lowest benchmark score among all peers.

52

RECORDS IN VIEW

33%

POSITIVE

14%

NEUTRAL

54%

NEGATIVE

39/100

PERCEPTION

01 MONTH IN REVIEW

Morocco's travel and tourism perception closed the October 2015 – June 2026 period in a structurally negative position, with a **perception score of 39 out of 100** and a **net sentiment of -21.2**. The dominant force is a majority of negative records — **53.8% of all content reviewed carried negative sentiment** — a share large enough to pull the overall score well below the neutral threshold of 50. The volume of adverse commentary concentrated heavily in 2016, which accounts for the largest single-year sample in the dataset, and that early weight has set a tone the subsequent years have not fully reversed.

The main drivers of negative perception are diffuse rather than thematic — no single aspect such as safety, hospitality, or food accumulates enough mentions to anchor a headline finding, but the direction of the commentary points toward governance, crime-linked associations, and hospitality concerns. Positive voices are genuine and emotionally warm, but they represent fewer than a third of all records, and their engagement is modest compared with the reach of the adverse content.

The single action the director should prioritise is a targeted content strategy aimed at 2016-vintage and post-2023 negative commentary, the two periods that most heavily weight the overall score downward. Flooding the channels where that negative content lives — YouTube, primarily — with credible, high-engagement positive material is the lever most likely to move perception in the near term.

DATA NOTE

The period label extends to June 2026, but annual trend records for 2026 cover only the portion of the year captured at report generation (August 2026); the 2026 annual score should be treated as partial-year and not compared directly to full-year figures for earlier periods.

02 PERCEPTION OVERVIEW

Morocco's **perception score of 39** places it below the neutral midpoint of 50 on the report's 0–100 scale, signalling that the market's overall standing in online travel discourse is actively negative rather than merely tepid. A score this far below 50 does not describe ambivalence; it describes a measurable reputational deficit. The **net sentiment of -21.2 points** — derived from a positive share of **32.7%** set against a negative share of **53.8%** — confirms the gap is not marginal. The **13.5% neutral share** is relatively small, meaning the audience engaging with Morocco travel content has formed an opinion, and the majority of those opinions are unfavourable.

What the mix implies for the market's standing is important to state plainly. Destinations with strong reputations typically show positive and neutral records together forming the clear majority, with negative content in the low-to-mid twenties or below. Morocco's inversion of that pattern — where negative records alone outnumber positive and neutral records combined — suggests the destination is not in a standard recovery mode; it is contending with a structurally adverse perception environment. The most important implication for budget allocation is that passive visibility campaigns are unlikely to help: the existing content environment is working against the destination, and new messaging has to compete with — and displace — a substantial volume of negative material already in circulation.

The emotional texture of the data adds nuance. Fearful content accounts for the largest identifiable emotional signal in the dataset, pointing to safety and reputation anxiety as the emotional register in which negative perceptions are being expressed. By contrast, excited and longing signals are present but slender. The marketing task, then, is not simply to amplify positives but to reduce the emotional grip of the fear register on prospective visitors.

DATA NOTE

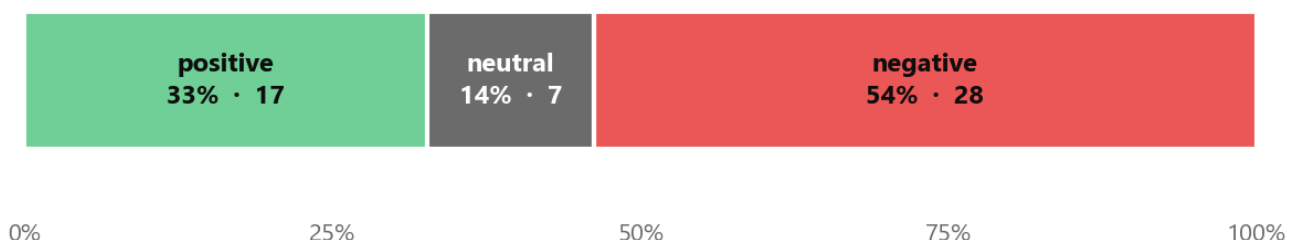
The positive, neutral, and negative percentages are based on 52 records, which clears the 50-record minimum threshold; the overall sentiment figures are reportable.

DATA NOTE

Emotion-level figures (fearful, longing, excited, disappointed) are each drawn from very small record counts and are presented as directional signals only, not as statistically stable findings.

Figure 1 — Sentiment breakdown

How the 52 records in view split across sentiment classes. Net sentiment is -21 points.



03 THEMATIC ANALYSIS

No aspect theme in this dataset reaches the 15-mention floor required to headline a finding, so the analysis describes the composition of the thematic mix without ranking any theme against another. That said, the shape of the evidence is informative. **Hospitality** attracts the highest mention count among all aspects tracked, and every mention in that group is negative — a unanimity that, while based on a sub-threshold sample, should register as a warning signal for the destination's service reputation. The voices most likely driving this signal concern interpersonal encounters rather than infrastructure, and the tourism board should treat hospitality as a watch category requiring further dedicated research before the next reporting cycle.

On the positive side, **transport** and **cost** lean favourable within their small samples. The most articulate positive voice in the dataset comes from @runwithjon (May 2024), who, en route to Morocco, remarked on "such a high quality train line" — a spontaneous, credible endorsement of infrastructure that campaigns could amplify without overstating. Cost perceptions also lean positive, suggesting Morocco's value proposition is at least partially landing. These are not yet reportable as headline strengths, but they are the raw material of a differentiated messaging platform if the sample can be built out.

The negative register is anchored by two distinct types of content. The first is politically and criminally charged commentary — exemplified by @MarkHorp (Aug 2017), who associated Moroccan nationals with "crimes, rape and terror acts all over Europe," and @dolfree1 (Feb 2016), who pointed to "obvious corruption in the Morocco government." These comments do not reflect the tourism product directly, but they circulate in the same YouTube environment as travel content and colour the decision-making of potential visitors. The second type is lighter in tone but persistent: dismissive or mocking commentary, such as @mohammedmejjane (Mar 2026), which contributes to a negative ambient sentiment without offering a specific grievance to address.

Food and scenery sit in ambiguous territory: both aspects show mixed sentiment with small samples that preclude firm conclusions. The research team recommends expanding the data collection scope — particularly to review platforms and travel blogs — to give food and scenery enough evidence to be properly assessed, as these are typically Morocco's strongest brand assets and their absence from a clearly positive position in this dataset is itself a finding worth investigating.

DATA NOTE

No theme reaches the 15-mention minimum required to headline a finding; all thematic observations in this section are indicative and should not be used to anchor budget decisions without further data collection.

DATA NOTE

The hospitality aspect's unanimously negative result is based on 7 mentions, well below the 15-mention threshold; it is flagged as a watch signal, not a confirmed finding.

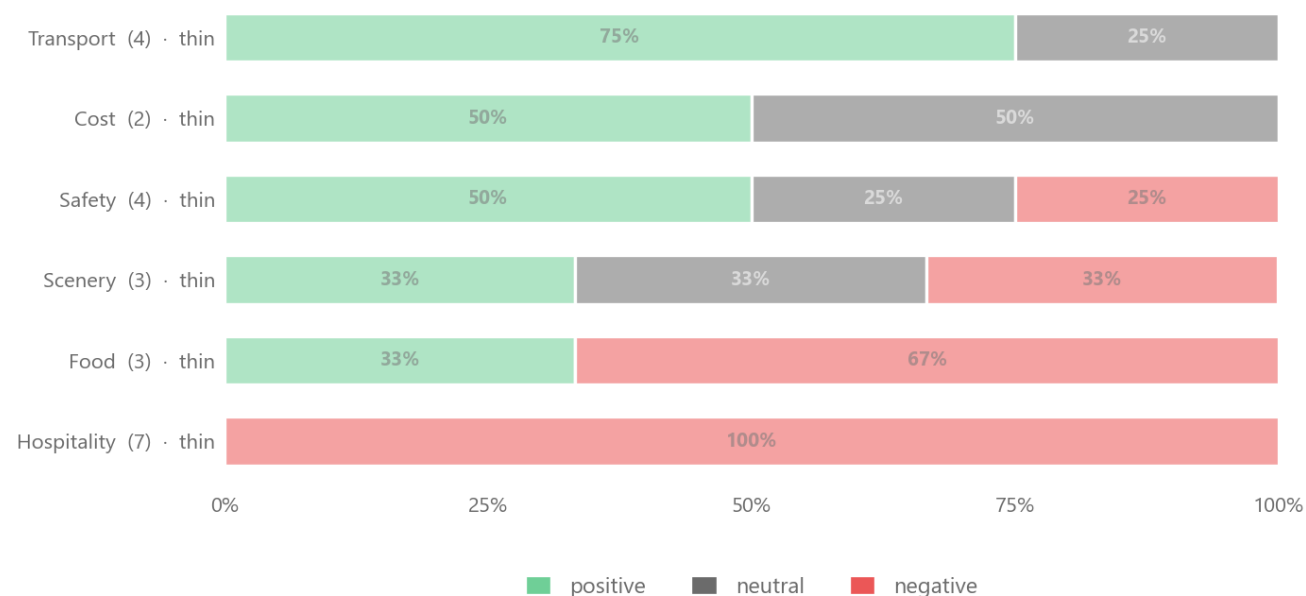
Voices behind the numbers

The most-engaged supportive and critical mentions in this view. Emoji and non-Latin characters are stripped for print.

POSITIVE · @mohammedbouzakri · Feb 2022 · 52 likes · score +0.82 “ ”
POSITIVE · @stophe8985 · Aug 2021 · 17 likes · score +0.91 “ #_ ”
NEGATIVE · @MarkHorp · Aug 2017 · 2 likes · score -0.92 “I can not imagine how it is now, when men from Morocco have been caught doing crimes, rape and terror acts all over Europe..”
NEGATIVE · @dolfree1 · Feb 2016 · 2 likes · score -0.87 “... how obvious is the corruption in the Morocco government ...”

Figure 2 — Sentiment by theme

Every travel theme mentioned in this view, ranked by net sentiment. Mention counts in brackets; themes below the 15-mention floor are faded and marked thin.



04 VISITOR SEGMENTS

Segment-level data is available in this dataset but cannot support cross-cohort comparisons. Only **5.8% of records were classified into a named visitor segment**, leaving **49 of 52 records unclassified**. Each of the three identifiable cohorts — luxury, business, and adventure — is represented by a single record apiece, far below the 50-record threshold the research team requires before a cohort's scores are treated as reportable. No cohort-to-cohort comparison can be drawn from this evidence, and no targeting inference based on cohort scores should be used to allocate budget.

What the segment picture does tell the director is structural: the data collection environment — YouTube transcripts and comments — is producing content that does not self-identify by traveller type. Visitors discussing Morocco online in this channel are speaking about the country rather than about themselves as a category of traveller. To build a usable segment picture, the research team would need to expand data collection to platforms where traveller identity is more explicitly declared: TripAdvisor (where business vs. leisure is often

stated), travel blogs with declared itinerary types, and Instagram or X content tagged with travel segment identifiers. Until that expansion occurs, Morocco's segment targeting strategy must rest on primary research rather than on this perception dataset.

DATA NOTE

No visitor segment cohort clears the 50-record minimum threshold; no cohort perception scores or net sentiment figures may be used to headline findings or anchor recommendations.

DATA NOTE

The 5.8% classification rate means the segment picture is structurally incomplete for this data source and period; the unclassified majority drives all reportable overall scores.

VISITOR SEGMENT	RECORDS	SHARE OF VIEW	PERCEPTION	NET
Luxury · thin	1	1.9%	12/100	-100
Business · thin	1	1.9%	26/100	-100
Adventure · thin	1	1.9%	17/100	-100

05 COMPETITIVE BENCHMARKING

Among the ten reportable destinations in this peer group, Morocco ranks **last, in position 10 of 10**, with a **perception score of 39**. Every other reportable peer scores above Morocco, and the gap to the group leader — Tanzania, at a perception score of **73** — stands at **34 points**, a deficit large enough to represent a structural competitive disadvantage rather than a cyclical dip. Even the lowest-scoring peers with reportable samples outperform Morocco comfortably: Nigeria, the next-closest, holds a perception score of **62**, and Egypt sits at **64** — both more than 20 points ahead.

The peer group's positive sentiment shares underscore Morocco's isolation at the bottom of the table. Tanzania leads with a positive share of **70.8%** and a negative share of **12.2%**; Ghana, Rwanda, Senegal, and Kenya each carry positive shares between **66.8%** and **69.6%** with negative shares well below 20%. Morocco's positive share of **32.7%** and negative share of **53.8%** are mirror images of the peer norm — the ratio of positive to negative is almost exactly the inverse of what the leading destinations achieve. South Africa, which faces its own reputational challenges, still holds a positive share of **59.3%** — nearly double Morocco's figure.

No theme-level benchmark gaps can be stated in this report: no aspect accumulates enough cross-country data to clear the 10-point gap margin the methodology requires. The overall-score comparison is therefore the primary competitive finding, and it is unambiguous. Morocco is not competing with its African peers for the same pool of travellers on anywhere near equal terms. Closing even half the gap to the bottom of the mid-table cluster — to somewhere near Nigeria's level — would represent a significant repositioning achievement and should be stated as the medium-term competitive target for the marketing strategy.

DATA NOTE

Cameroon's peer record (16 records) does not clear the 50-record minimum and is excluded from all comparative statements; the effective reportable peer group is 10 destinations including Morocco.

DATA NOTE

No theme-level gap clears the 10-point margin required for a reportable cross-country thematic comparison; benchmarking is confined to overall perception scores and sentiment distributions.

MARKET	RECORDS	PERCEPTION	NET SENTIMENT
Tanzania	1,326	73/100	+59
Ghana	1,094	70/100	+52
Rwanda	1,526	70/100	+54
Senegal	1,114	70/100	+50
Kenya	2,075	69/100	+52
Zimbabwe	1,186	68/100	+50
South Africa	2,164	65/100	+39
Egypt	2,305	64/100	+36
Nigeria	1,884	62/100	+33
Morocco	52	39/100	-21

06 TRENDS & SIGNALS

The ten-year arc of Morocco's perception score is declining: the dataset opens in 2015 at a score of **58** and closes in 2026 at **46**, a fall of **12 points** over the full period. That headline direction, however, conceals a pattern of sharp year-to-year swings that is itself a significant finding. The score dropped to **30** in 2016 — the dataset's highest-volume year with 32 records — then recovered partially in 2017 before spiking to **93** in 2018 and **92** in 2019. It reached its highest recorded point of **96** in 2021, fell to **79** in 2022, collapsed to **6** in 2023, recovered to **74** in 2024, and has since retreated again: **51** in 2025 and **46** in the partial 2026 record.

The volatility is the signal. Years outside 2016 and 2023 each carry very few records — in several cases just one or two — so the apparent peaks and troughs in those years are not stable estimates of annual perception; they reflect the sentiment of a handful of posts. The research team flags this prominently: the 2016 result, with 32 records, is the only annual figure that carries enough weight to be treated as a genuine measure of annual sentiment, and it is negative. The 2025 and partial 2026 figures, with four and three records respectively, are directional rather than definitive.

What is readable with confidence is the movement within aspects across the period. **Safety, scenery, and food all show improving trajectories** when comparing first-half to second-half mentions, with negative sentiment falling in each case — though all three remain below the mention threshold required to treat this improvement as a confirmed trend. The direction is consistent and worth monitoring: if the overall volume of content grows in coming months and these aspect-level improvements hold, safety and food in particular could shift from watch categories to genuine positive differentiators. The priority signal for the director is the **partial 2026 result of 46**, which combined with a negative rate of **66.7%** in that year's records, suggests perception is trending adverse again as the current period closes — not a time to reduce marketing investment.

DATA NOTE

Annual perception scores for all years other than 2016 (32 records) are based on between 1 and 4 records; they are directional indicators only and should not be quoted as stable annual benchmarks.

DATA NOTE

The 2026 annual figure covers only the portion of the year up to the report generation date and is a partial-year result.

DATA NOTE

Figure 3 — Perception over time (by year)

Perception score per period on a 0–100 scale, where 50 is neutral.

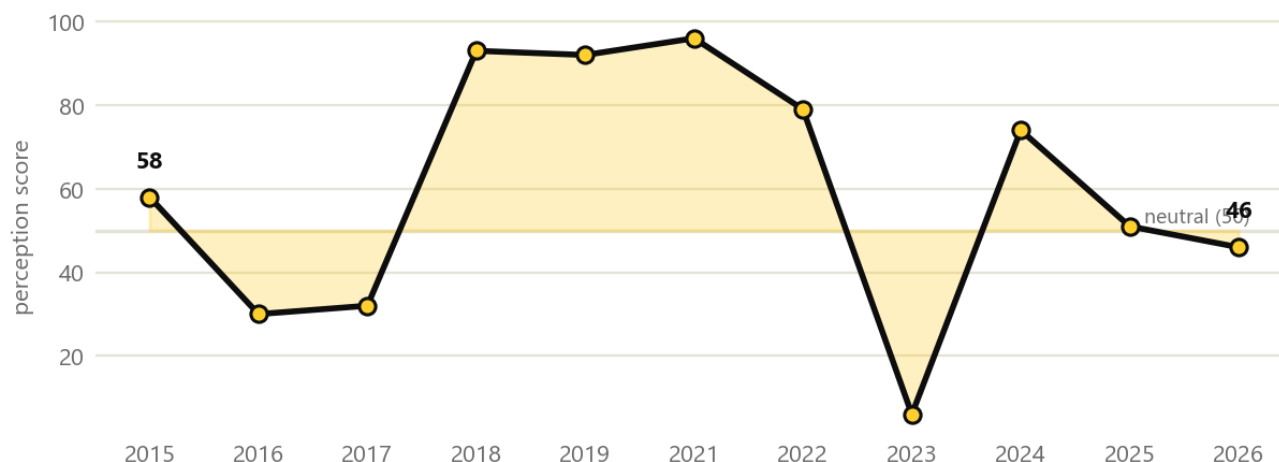
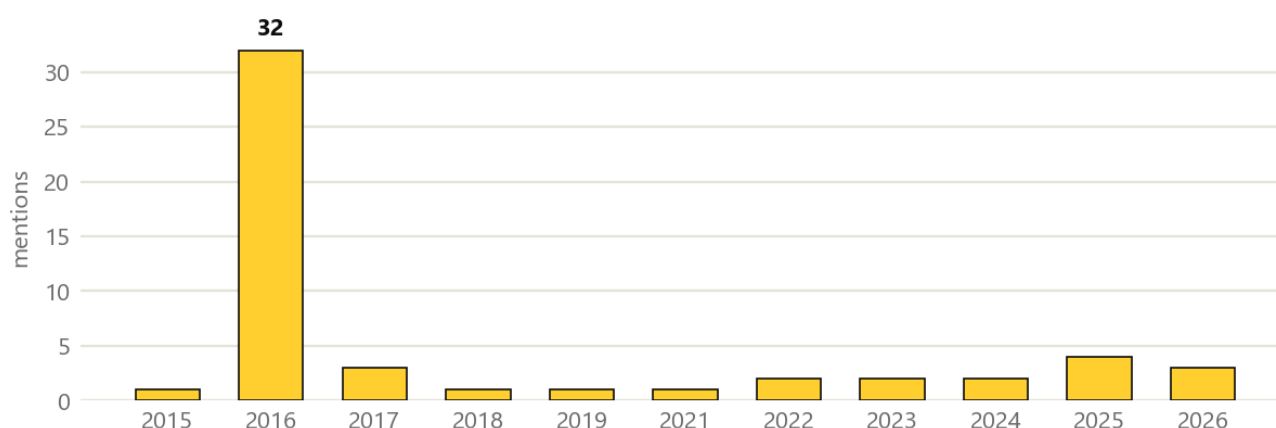


Figure 4 — Conversation volume (by year)

Records per period. Read the trend above against this: a swing on thin volume is noise.



07 RECOMMENDATIONS

The first recommendation is triggered by Morocco's **last-place ranking among all reportable peers** and the concentration of negative records in YouTube, which accounts for the entire dataset. The tourism board should commission a sustained YouTube content partnership programme — not one-off sponsored videos but a series of high-production, high-engagement travel documentaries co-created with mid-tier creators (100k–2M subscribers) whose audiences overlap with prospective Morocco visitors from Europe and North America. The goal is to generate enough credible positive volume to dilute the negative ambient content from 2016 that continues to anchor the overall score downward. The target audience for this programme is the undecided first-time visitor from Europe and the Gulf, the groups most likely to encounter the existing negative commentary before booking.

The second recommendation addresses the **hospitality aspect's unanimously negative signal**. Even though the mention count is sub-threshold, a pattern this one-directional in any aspect warrants a direct response. The board should brief the national hospitality and guiding sector — via ONMT and regional tourism clusters — on the specific nature of the interpersonal complaints surfacing in online travel content, and commission a mystery-visitor audit of the highest-volume tourist interaction points (medina guides, riad check-ins, souk

vendors). The findings of that audit should inform a service-quality training intervention delivered before the next peak season. The target audience is the frontline hospitality workforce in Marrakech, Fes, and Chefchaouen, the destinations most likely to generate this content type.

Third, the **transport theme's positive lean and the spontaneous infrastructure endorsement** from @runwithjon (May 2024) point to an underexploited asset. Morocco's rail network — in particular the Al Boraq high-speed line — is generating genuine, unprompted praise from international visitors, yet this asset receives minimal weight in international marketing materials. The board should integrate infrastructure modernity explicitly into the destination's digital content strategy: short-form video of the train journey experience, timed to the content partnership programme above, would give the positive transport signal the amplification it currently lacks. The target is the European city-break and cultural travel segment, for whom transport quality is a meaningful trip decision factor.

Finally, the **near-term perception decline visible in the 2025–2026 partial data** — from a score of 51 in 2025 to 46 in early 2026, with a negative rate of 66.7% in the most recent records — argues against any budget reduction in the current cycle. The board should treat the 2026 partial score as an early-warning indicator and schedule a quarterly perception pulse — using a minimum 50-record threshold — to track whether the negative drift accelerates or reverses before the next annual report. A monitoring protocol, not just an annual report, is the appropriate operational response to a destination whose perception is both structurally low and demonstrably volatile.

DATA NOTE

The hospitality-based recommendation rests on a sub-threshold aspect sample (7 mentions); the recommendation is framed as a watch-and-investigate action rather than a confirmed strategic priority.

DATA NOTE

The 2026 trend-based recommendation derives from a partial-year figure with only 3 records; it is treated as a directional signal warranting monitoring, not as a stable annual result.

08

METHODOLOGY & PROVENANCE

Country	Morocco
Year range	2015–2026
Aspect (any of)	all aspects
Sentiment	positive, neutral, negative
Data source	all
Relevant records only	yes
Period	October 2015 – June 2026
Records	52
Generated	19 Aug 2026 12:28 UTC
Narrative	Written by claude-sonnet-4-6; every figure verified against the computed data.

Evidence base: 30 YouTube transcript segments, 22 YouTube comments. 100% of records were attributed to this market from what the text itself is about rather than from the query that surfaced them. Sentiment is scored by a multilingual transformer; themes, emotion and visitor segment are rule-based taggers. Evidence thresholds: 50 records for a reliable view, 15 mentions before a theme can headline a finding, 5 points before a theme counts as praised or criticised, 10 points before a cross-country gap is stated. Every figure in this report is computed from the filtered records by the analysis pipeline. The written analysis interprets those figures; each number it states is verified back against them before publication, and any section that fails verification is replaced by the deterministic summary.